

Re: Support for Village of Saranac Lake Smart Growth Grant Application – Lake Colby Beach House Accessibility Upgrades (Contractual Services)

Dear Review Committee,

I am writing to express strong support for the Village of Saranac Lake's Smart Growth Grant application to fund contractual services for the Lake Colby Beach House accessibility upgrades.

Lake Colby Beach is not only a treasured space for the Village of Saranac Lake, but also for families and visitors from across Franklin County. Each summer, the beach serves as a regional hub for recreation, drawing people from throughout the county to swim, gather, and enjoy the outdoors. Unfortunately, the current facilities limit access for individuals with mobility challenges, preventing full use of this public asset.

This grant funding will allow the Village to contract professional services, architectural, engineering, and construction expertise, to design and implement ADA-compliant bathrooms, lifeguard facilities, and accessible pathways. These improvements will ensure that Lake Colby Beach becomes a fully inclusive and safe destination, benefitting not only local residents but also strengthening Franklin County's appeal as a welcoming place to live, work, and visit.

By investing in accessibility at Lake Colby Beach, this project advances Smart Growth principles while improving regional quality of life, promoting equitable access, and supporting sustainable tourism across Franklin County.

I strongly encourage your favorable consideration of this application.

Sincerely,

Phil Hans
Economic Development & Tourism Director
Franklin County